Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Gabon/Loi de finances 2027 : les budgets de la Communication et de l'Économie numérique examinés à l'Assemblée nationale** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 25 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's National Assembly examined the 2027 budget requests of the communication and digital economy ministries on 25 October. The digital economy ministry asks for FCFA 37.2 billion in 2027, down about FCFA 16.5 billion from FCFA 53.7 billion in 2026, for connectivity, digital sovereignty and modernising the administration, while the communication ministry's request rises to FCFA 21.5 billion from FCFA 17.5 billion. *Also under Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure.*

- **Burkina Faso : vers la création d'un fonds de soutien aux startups numériques ?** — Digital Magazine Burkina, 25 October 2026 BURKINA FASO

  Burkina Faso's digital transition ministry met startups, SMEs, incubators, universities and partners in Ouagadougou on 21 October 2026 to gather their expectations for two projects in preparation: the services of a planned Mini-Technopôle TIC de Ouagadougou and a support fund for digital startups. The fund's amounts, eligibility rules and timetable are still to be set once the consultation ends. *Also under Innovation ecosystem.*

- **Bridging the Digital Divide: Assessing the Interplay of Digital Literacy, Infrastructure, and Policy in Shaping Sierra Leone's Digital Entrepreneurship Ecosystem** — International Journal of Science and Business, 25 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  A paper by Alusine Boys Conteh and Peter Jesse Saxo-Decker surveyed 200 people running or planning digital businesses in Freetown, Bo and Makeni on Sierra Leone's digital entrepreneurship ecosystem. Only 12.5% judged the policy and regulatory framework effective, against 35% for digital literacy and 30% for infrastructure, with half unable to describe the policy environment at all; the authors conclude that policy clarity may be the most neglected factor and make recommendations to MoCTI, DSTI and development partners. *Also under Digital divides and Literacy.*

Data protection

- **NDPC Urges Responsible AI Use, Data Protection** — Voice of Nigeria, 25 October 2026 NIGERIA

  At the Kano Social Influencers Summit organised by CITAD, the Nigeria Data Protection Commission warned influencers, developers and users against misusing personal data, urging them to verify content, disclose AI-generated material and not use people's faces, voices or data without authorisation. It said breaches of the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023 and its implementation directive can draw financial penalties, and set out citizens' rights to access, correct and in some cases delete their data. *Also under AI.*

- **CITAD tasks FG on indigenous AI technology, stronger data protection** — Blueprint Newspapers Limited, 25 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Opening the seventh Kano Social Influencers Summit, the Centre for Information Technology and Development (CITAD) urged Nigeria's federal government to invest in home-grown AI rather than buying foreign products, and to hold foreign technology companies accountable for the data they collect from Nigerians. Its executive director Yunusa Zakari Ya'u said much of the country's data is still analogue and fragmented, and that reliable electricity and water are preconditions for data centres. *Also under AI and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Zimbabwe wants digital payments to build trust in its newest currency. Why technology alone won't be enough to save the ZiG** — The Conversation, 25 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's central bank is in talks with NPCI International, the overseas arm of the body behind India's instant-payment system, on a real-time payment system meant to cut costs, move money faster between bank accounts and mobile wallets and make the gold-backed ZiG easier to use. The author, a trade policy researcher, argues the technology will only help the currency if Zimbabwean institutions keep control of the system, people can still pick freely between the ZiG and the US dollar, and monetary policy is credible, given the country's history of hyperinflation and failed currencies. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech and Digital sovereignty.*

- **South Africa's AI strategy must be pro-employment** — Daily Maverick, 25 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  In an opinion piece, Ravi Naidoo argues that South Africa, with 34% of working-age people and 60% of under-25s unemployed, should steer AI adoption towards augmenting workers rather than replacing them. He proposes treating AI job displacement as a negative externality to be restricted or taxed, with pro-employment uses rewarded, through an AI Skills Augmentation Act and a business code of practice added to the King Codes, and rights for people over their own face, body and voice modelled on Denmark's copyright amendment. *Also under AI.*

- **Bright Simons flags computing capacity error in Ghana's AI strategy and questions GhanaChat costs** — MyJoyOnline, 25 October 2026 GHANA

  IMANI's Bright Simons argued that Ghana's national AI strategy misprints its computing targets, giving 10^{21} and 10^{25} FLOPS as '1021' and '1025', and that the 2027 target read correctly would mean some 200,000 top-end chips and 500 MW of power costing about US$24 billion, about a hundred times what the US$250 million AI data centre under procurement would provide. He questioned the value of GhanaChat, the ministry's planned national AI model, putting the data centre's likely subsidy near US$61 million annually, and suggested starting with a government-hosted AI assistant for civil servants on roughly 144 GPUs, at US$13 million up front. *Also under AI and Technical Capacity.*

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  Summarised under Data protection.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

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  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Deux projets numériques de 30 millions de dollars passés en revue, avec un appel à accélérer** — ADI Djibouti, 25 October 2026 DJIBOUTI

  Djibouti's minister Mohamed Abdoulkader Moussa reviewed two IDA-funded digital projects with the regulator ARMD and the state information systems agency ANSIE and called for faster implementation. The US$10 million DFN project has completed 26 of 35 activities, with nearly 80% of funds committed and 56% disbursed, before it closes on 30 June 2027; the US$20 million EARDIP's cross-border links, twelve 4G sites and fibre loops to Dikhil, Tadjourah and Obock still await approval of commercial, environmental and social studies. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

Technical Capacity

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  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Nigerians Recount Frustrating Experiences With NIMC Over Data Correction, Failed Verification** — The Trumpet, 25 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigerians describe repeated visits to National Identity Management Commission offices without getting errors in their records corrected, with one applicant who made five trips before paying informal roadside agents to get her record changed. Others report time-outs on NIMC's mobile app and portal and failed NIN-SIM verification that left phone lines unusable, while an NIMC staff member blamed recurring network failures for disrupting service. *Also under Access to services.*

Digital Payments and Fintech

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Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **BUTIHINDA : La digitalisation de la gestion comptable, budgétaire et financière se modernise grâce au logiciel AK-SOFT** — Commune de Butihinda, 25 October 2026 BURUNDI

  Butihinda commune in Burundi held a practical session on 24 and 25 October 2026 for its zonal assistant accountants and tax collectors on AK-SOFT, integrated software for communal accounting, budget and financial management, following a Primature workshop for communal finance officers at Buhumuza on 20 to 23 October. Staff are entering the commune's revenue and spending from 1 July 2025 through the first quarter of fiscal 2026-27; participants asked for more training and said they need stable internet and continuing technical support. *Also under Digitalisation of sub-national government.*

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Summarised under Connectivity.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

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Technology

AI

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Innovation ecosystem

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Capacity

Literacy

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Digital divides

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Geopolitics

Digital sovereignty

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.